PARTY GAME PACK

# Gingerbread House Contest Kit

Score cards, ballots and certificates for kids, teen and adult divisions

15 PAGES

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GM's Digital Creations

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# How to Run Your Contest

Everything prints on US Letter (fits A4). Print the pages you need, cut the cards on the dashed lines and you are ready.

## The plan in six steps

1. Pick a date, a build time (60 to 90 minutes works well) and a theme if you want one, then fill in the Host Plan on page 3.
2. Print the Team Sign-Up Sheet and let guests form teams of 1 to 4 people. Each team picks the division that matches its oldest builder.
3. Read the Official Rules out loud before the timer starts, and hand every team a Build Plan page to sketch their house.
4. When time is up, judges walk the table with one Score Card per team and rate five criteria from 1 to 5.
5. Add the judges' points on the Results Tally Sheet. The highest total in each division wins; ties go to the higher Creativity score.
6. Guests vote with People's Choice ballots, then you hand out the certificates while everyone admires the houses.

## What is inside

- [ ] Host plan and supply checklist
- [ ] Official rules and divisions
- [ ] Team sign-up sheet
- [ ] Team build plan
- [ ] Judge score cards (2 per page)
- [ ] Judging guide for fair scores
- [ ] Results tally sheet
- [ ] People's Choice ballots (8 per page)
- [ ] 12 award categories
- [ ] Certificates for kids, teens, adults and special awards

## Divisions

KIDS

### Ages 12 and under

A grown-up may hold walls while the icing sets.

TEENS

### Ages 13 to 17

Teens build on their own or in teen-only teams.

ADULTS

### Ages 18 and up

Mixed-age teams enter here.

HOST

# Host Plan and Supply Checklist

Fill this in a week before the party so the day runs itself.

| DETAIL | YOUR PLAN |
|---|---|
| Contest date | |
| Start time / build time | |
| Theme (optional) | |
| Judges (2 or 3 people) | |
| Prizes | |
| Where houses will be displayed | |

## Supplies

- [ ] Gingerbread house kit or baked walls, one per team
- [ ] Royal icing in piping bags (2 per team)
- [ ] Sturdy base: cake board, cutting board or foil-covered cardboard
- [ ] Candy bowls: gumdrops, peppermints, pretzels, candy canes
- [ ] Cereal, mini marshmallows and shredded coconut for snow
- [ ] Canned goods or cups to hold walls while icing sets
- [ ] Paper towels, wet wipes and table covers
- [ ] Timer or phone alarm, pens for judges
- [ ] Printed score cards, ballots and certificates
- [ ] A small prize for each division winner

## Party timeline

| TIME | WHAT HAPPENS |
|---|---|
| 30 min before | Set out bases, icing and candy bowls; tape team names to each spot |
| Start | Welcome, read the rules, hand out build plans |
| 5 min | Teams sketch their plan |
| Build | 60 to 90 minutes of building; call out the halfway point |
| Judging | Judges score while guests vote People's Choice |
| Awards | Read winners from the tally sheet and hand out certificates |

# Official Contest Rules

Read these out loud before the timer starts.

1. Every house must stand on its own base. Bases may not be shared between teams.
2. Everything on the house must be edible except the base and any support cans removed before judging.
3. Teams may bring up to three special candies from home; everything else comes from the shared bowls.
4. Build time is set by the host. When the timer ends, hands off; no more icing or candy.
5. Walls may be propped while the icing sets but must stand alone at judging.
6. Kids may get help holding walls from one grown-up. Decorating is done by the kids.
7. Judges score each house on five criteria from 1 to 5, for a top score of 25 per judge.
8. Judges may not score a team they belong to. If they do, the host drops that card.
9. Ties are broken by the higher Creativity score, then by a coin toss.
10. Be kind. Every builder gets a cheer when the winners are read.

## Our house rules

Add your own rules here, such as a theme, a candy limit or a surprise ingredient.

# Team Sign-Up Sheet

Write each team's name, builders and division. The table number tells judges where to find them.

| # | TEAM NAME | BUILDERS | DIVISION | TABLE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | |
| 2 | | | | |
| 3 | | | | |
| 4 | | | | |
| 5 | | | | |
| 6 | | | | |
| 7 | | | | |
| 8 | | | | |
| 9 | | | | |
| 10 | | | | |
| 11 | | | | |
| 12 | | | | |
| 13 | | | | |
| 14 | | | | |

PLAN

# Team Build Plan

Five minutes to plan before you pipe. Sketch the front of your house and list your candy jobs.

| TEAM NAME | DIVISION | TABLE |
|---|---|---|
| | | |

SKETCH THE FRONT OF YOUR HOUSE

## Our theme or story

| JOB | WHO DOES IT |
|---|---|
| Walls and roof | |
| Icing and snow | |
| Doors and windows | |
| Roof decoration | |
| Yard and path | |

# Judge Score Cards

One card per team per judge. Circle a score for each line and add the total.

## Judge Score Card

TOTAL OUT OF 25

Team _____ Judge _____

Division ☐ Kids ☐ Teens ☐ Adults

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Creativity**<br>Original idea, theme or story | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| **Structure**<br>Walls and roof stand straight and strong | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| **Decoration detail**<br>Careful candy work, patterns and texture | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| **Neat icing**<br>Clean lines and seams | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| **Wow factor**<br>How it looks from across the room | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

Comments _____ **Total** /25

## Judge Score Card

TOTAL OUT OF 25

Team _____ Judge _____

Division ☐ Kids ☐ Teens ☐ Adults

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Creativity**<br>Original idea, theme or story | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| **Structure**<br>Walls and roof stand straight and strong | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| **Decoration detail**<br>Careful candy work, patterns and texture | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| **Neat icing**<br>Clean lines and seams | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| **Wow factor**<br>How it looks from across the room | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

Comments _____ **Total** /25

# Judging Guide

Share this with judges so a 3 means the same thing at every table.

| CRITERION | 1 POINT | 3 POINTS | 5 POINTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Creativity | Plain kit house | A clear theme or one surprise detail | An idea nobody else had, carried all the way through |
| Structure | Walls lean or roof slides | Stands straight with small gaps | Square, sturdy, clean corners, nothing propped |
| Decoration detail | Candy placed at random | Some patterns and texture | Planned patterns, layered textures, tiny details |
| Neat icing | Smudged and drippy | Mostly tidy seams | Crisp lines, even piping, clean snow |
| Wow factor | Easy to walk past | Makes people stop | Everyone gathers around it |

## Tips for judges

- Score each house on its own, then compare across a division only to break ties.
- Use 2 and 4 for houses between the descriptions.
- Kids are judged against kids, teens against teens, adults against adults.
- Judges never score their own family's team.

## Tie breakers

1. Higher Creativity score wins.
2. Still tied: higher Wow factor score.
3. Still tied: coin toss by the youngest guest.

## A sample scored card: 21 out of 25

| CRITERION | SCORE | WHY THE JUDGE GAVE IT |
|---|---|---|
| Creativity | 5 | A ski lodge with a pretzel ski rack and a frozen pond |
| Structure | 4 | Straight walls, roof slipped a little on one side |
| Decoration detail | 4 | Peppermint path and shingles in rows |
| Neat icing | 3 | Snow is neat, seams are smudged |
| Wow factor | 5 | Guests crowded around it |

# Results Tally Sheet

Copy each judge's card total. Add across for the team total (top score 75 with three judges).

| TEAM | DIVISION | JUDGE 1 | JUDGE 2 | JUDGE 3 | TOTAL | RANK |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | |
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VOTE

# People's Choice Ballots

Every guest gets one vote. Cut on the dashed lines.

## People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

## People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

## People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

## People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

## People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

## People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

## People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

## People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

AWARDS

# 12 Award Categories

Give the Grand Champion in each division, then add as many special awards as you have builders.

| AWARD | GIVEN FOR |
|---|---|
| Grand Champion | Highest total score in the division |
| Golden Gumdrop | Best use of colorful candy |
| Rooftop Royalty | Best roof: shingles, snow or tiles |
| Sturdiest Build | Still standing straight at the end |
| Pretzel Architect | Most creative use of pretzels |
| Winter Wonderland | Best snow scene and yard |
| Master Piper | Neatest icing work |
| Window Wizard | Best doors and windows |
| Story Builder | Best theme or story |
| Most Delicious | The one everyone wants to eat |
| Team Spirit | Best teamwork and kindness |
| People's Choice | Most guest votes |

# Kids Division Certificates

Write the builder or team name and sign. Cut on the dashed line.

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

## Grand Champion

proudly presented to

for building the top-scoring gingerbread house in the Kids Division

Judge

Date

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

## Golden Gumdrop

proudly presented to

for the most colorful candy work in the Kids Division

Judge

Date

# Teen Division Certificates

Write the builder or team name and sign. Cut on the dashed line.

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

## Grand Champion

proudly presented to

for building the top-scoring gingerbread house in the Teen Division

Judge

Date

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

## Rooftop Royalty

proudly presented to

for the best roof in the Teen Division

Judge

Date

ADULTS

# Adult Division Certificates

Write the builder or team name and sign. Cut on the dashed line.

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

## Grand Champion

proudly presented to

for building the top-scoring gingerbread house in the Adult Division

Judge

Date

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

## Master Piper

proudly presented to

for the neatest icing work in the Adult Division

Judge

Date

ANY DIVISION

# Special Award Certificates

Write the builder or team name and sign. Cut on the dashed line.

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

## People's Choice

proudly presented to

for winning the most guest votes at our gingerbread house contest

Judge

Date

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

## Special Award

proudly presented to

for a gingerbread house that made everyone smile

Judge

Date